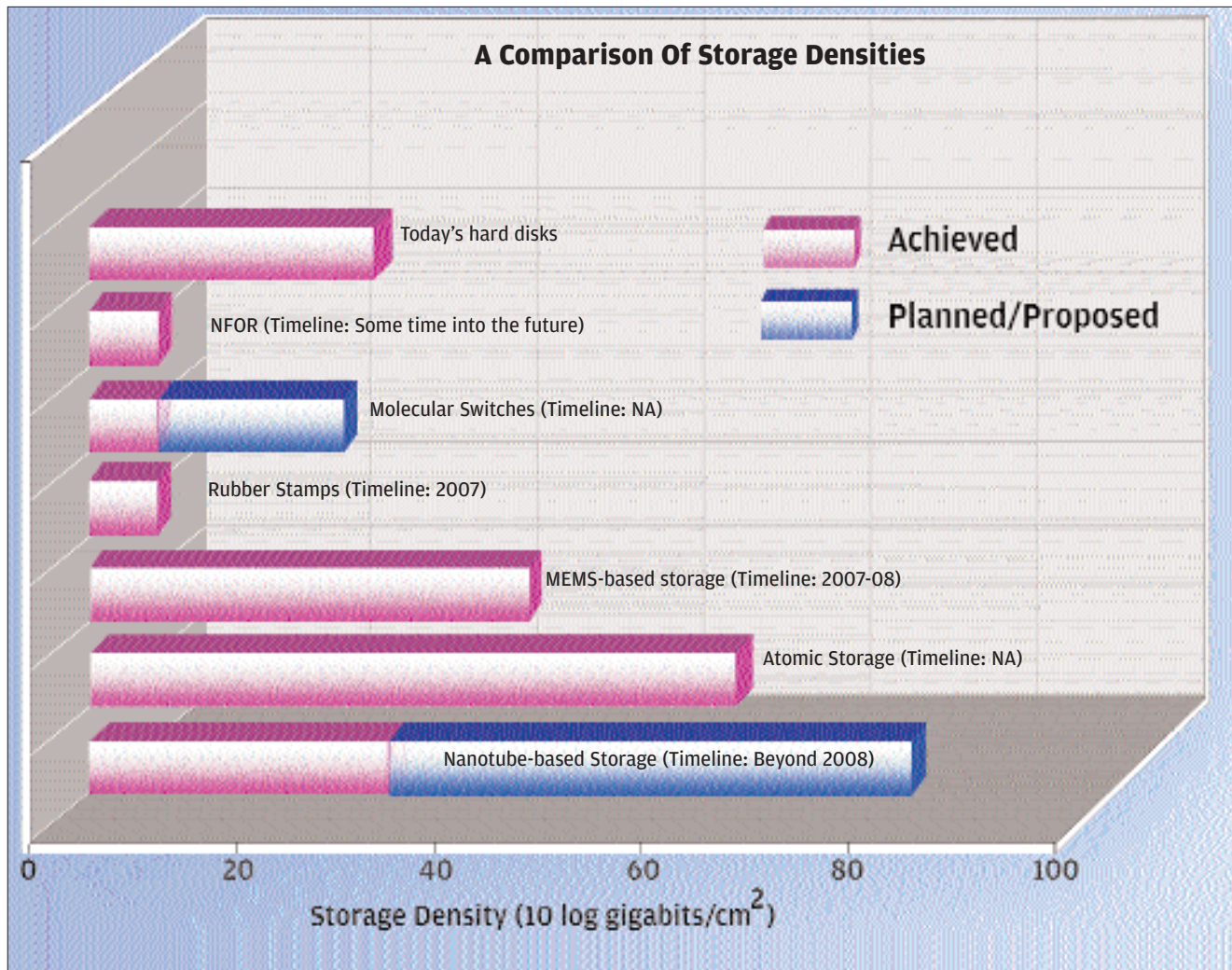




How Much, And When?

If you've read this far, you probably want to know exactly when you're going to be able to upgrade! The graph above indicates storage densities (on a logarithmic scale) and timelines. Though the hard disk seems pretty mighty in this graph, there are other considerations—for example, they've pretty much reached their theoretical limit; there's only so much you can pack onto a single platter; and access times are shorter with,

for example, MEMS-based and holographic storage.

With so many labs doing so much work, standardisation is going to be a huge issue. Also, the technologies will directly compete with each other—so even just two years down the line, the scene is likely to be quite different. In any case, it's almost time to look lovingly at your hard disk and pay your last respects! ☒

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AD